

Standard Chartered

Broad-based performance with Wealth fireworks

StanChart's 2Q performance was strong and broad-based, with Attributable profits 17% ahead of company-compiled consensus, driven by income 3% ahead and pre-provision profits 9% ahead. We expect low-mid single digit% upgrades to consensus EPS FY26-28E, with stronger revenues (with further upside from higher rates) partly offset by higher costs, reflecting upgraded FY26E total income guidance to the middle of the 5-7% range (vs cons. 6.4%) which looks conservative considering the momentum in non-Interest income. Wealth (+43% y/y and 16% above expectations) had a strong quarter with \$15bn of net new money, alongside Banking (+18% y/y), while Markets flow income (+16% y/y) offset weaker Episodic income as flagged. NII was 1% ahead supported by +2% q/q loan & deposit growth, with FY26 NII guidance upgraded to low single-digit% growth (vs cons. +2% y/y) despite a higher time deposit mix expected within WRB. The Group saw 76k Affluent new to bank clients in 2Q and the pace of onboarding remained unchanged through the quarter, against the backdrop of ODI changes as of 1 July. Expenses were 2% lower than expectations (and broadly in line excluding \$74m Korea provision release), with FY26 costs ex-notables expected at c\$13.3bn (in line). CET1 was 14.2% (vs cons. 13.8%) with RWAs c\$5bn lower q/q although are expected to largely reverse in 2H, and the Group announced a \$1bn SBB (vs cons. \$1.1bn) and DPS of 20.4c (vs cons. 17.8c). We remain OW, with the stock trading at 10.2x PE, 1.4x PNAV for a ROTE of 14.9% 27E.

- **Noteworthy Areas:** 1) NII of \$2.87bn was 1% above cons. and flat q/q with volume growth, day count and asset mix benefits offset by lower rates and WRB portfolio actions. AIEAs were flat q/q with underlying loans +2% q/q driven by CIB loans +\$4.9bn q/q while WRB loans were +\$1.7bn q/q, and underlying deposits were +2% q/q driven by both CIB (+\$5.7bn, largely CASA) and WRB deposits (+\$5.2bn q/q) with net new money flows into term deposits resulting in a c2%-pt move in CASA/TD mix. 2) Other income of \$2.83bn (including DVA of -\$57mn) was 5% above cons. mainly driven strong growth in Wealth Solutions (+43% y/y) as well as Global Banking (+18% y/y) and Transaction Services (+5% y/y). Total income was \$5.70bn and 3% above cons. 3) Costs of \$3.20bn were 2% lower than cons. and included a \$74mn provision release related to Korea ELS, driving PPOP of \$2.51bn 9% above cons. 4) Credit impairments of \$150m (20bps loan loss rate) were 37% below cons. and included \$44m additional overlays, driving PBT of \$2.33bn 13% above cons. 5) CET1 of 14.2% was 50bps above cons. with RWAs 2% below cons. and -2% q/q; 6) TNAV/sh was \$17.55 vs cons. \$17.80; 7) DPS of 20.4c was 15% above cons. and buyback of \$1bn was lower vs cons. \$1.1bn.
- **Outlook & Guidance: 2026 NII and Income guidance upgraded:** 1) Reported income growth to be around the middle of the 5-7% range y/y (prev bottom-end of range), implying 2026E revenues of \$22.05bn (vs cons. \$22.17bn), with NII to increase low single-digit % y/y (cons. +1.7% y/y). 2) Reported costs (ex notables) expected to be c\$13.3bn (vs cons. \$13.34bn). 3) 2026 statutory RoTE guidance of >12% unchanged (cons. 13.1%). 4) H2 26 NII to be driven by continued volume growth and asset mix benefit, offset by changes in deposit mix in WRB and continued impact of WRB portfolio actions. 5) H2 26 RWAs expected to see reversal of the \$4.7bn decline in Q2

Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (28 Jul 26):2,097p

Price Target (Dec-27):2270.0p

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as well as the Q4 increase in op. risk RWAs.

- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX):** 2Q: 1) Wealth +43% y/y (16% above cons.) with \$15bn net new money or 14% of AUM annualized, with \$9bn in Wealth (15% of Wealth AUM annualized); 76k new-to-bank affluent clients were onboarded. 2) Global Markets -5% y/y (1% below cons.) with Flow income (+16% y/y) offset by episodic income (-47% y/y against a strong Q2'25). 3) Global Banking +18% y/y (6% above cons) with Lending & Fin Solutions +15% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory +46% y/y. 4) Transaction Services +5% y/y (3% above cons.) with Payments & Liquidity +3% y/y.
- **Likely changes to consensus:** We expect low-mid single digit% upgrades to consensus EPS FY26-28E, with stronger revenues (and potential upside to management's FY26 total income guidance) partly offset by higher costs given CIR guidance remains unchanged.
- **Peer read-across:** We see these results as a positive read-across for HSBC's Wealth revenues with StanChart Wealth income growth of +43% y/y in 2Q alongside net new money of \$15bn (inc. \$9bn in Wealth). The Group also saw an increase in time deposit migration with more expected, which we could also see at HSBC given the outlook on interest rates.
- **Conference Call Details:** 08.00 UK [here](#)

Actual vs Expected:

Table 1: StanChart 2Q Group results

\$mn

	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	2Q26 Cons	2Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,702	2,869	2,810	2,839	2,871	1%	2%	6%	0%
Other Income	2,825	3,033	2,689	2,708	2,831	5%	5%	0%	-7%
Revenue	5,527	5,902	5,499	5,547	5,702	3%	4%	3%	-3%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,471	1,512	1,521	1,498	1,542	3%	1%	5%	2%
o.w. Global Banking	548	663	605	617	651	6%	8%	19%	-2%
o.w. Global Markets	1,172	1,190	1,116	1,125	1,116	-1%	0%	-5%	-6%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	742	1,043	899	916	1,064	16%	18%	43%	2%
Operating expenses	-3,201	-3,140	-3,316	-3,252	-3,196	-2%	-4%	0%	2%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,326	2,762	2,183	2,295	2,506	9%	15%	8%	-9%
Loan impairments	-119	-296	-243	-239	-150	-37%	-38%	26%	-49%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	2,207	2,466	1,941	2,056	2,356	15%	21%	7%	-4%
Other impairments	-4	-2	-6	-9	-19				
Profit from associates	77	-14	5	17	-3				
Clean Pretax profits	2,280	2,450	1,940	2,064	2,334	13%	20%	2%	-5%
DPS	0.12		0.20	0.18	0.20	15%	0%	65%	-
TNAV/s	\$16.80	\$17.20	\$17.88	\$17.80	\$17.55	-1%	-2%	4%	2%
CET1 ratio	14.3%	13.4%	13.6%	13.7%	14.2%				
RWAs	260	266	268	268	262	-2%	-2%	1%	-2%
Loans (amortised cost)	287	294	295	296	299	1%	1%	4%	2%
Customer deposits	517	542	550	554	553	0%	0%	7%	2%
SBB	1,300		1,000	1,119	1000	-11%	0%	-23%	

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 2: StanChart 2Q product revenues

\$mn

	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	2Q26 Cons	2Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,471	1,512	1,521	1,498	1,542	3%	1%	5%	2%
Payments and Liquidity	1,015	1,037	1,053	1,028	1,047	2%	-1%	3%	1%
Securities Services	158	177	167	173	182	5%	9%	15%	3%
Trade & Working Capital	298	298	301	297	313	5%	4%	5%	5%
Banking	548	663	605	617	651	6%	8%	19%	-2%
Lending & Financial Solutions	476	511	514	522	546	5%	6%	15%	7%
Capital Maket & Advisory	72	152	91	96	105	9%	15%	46%	-31%
Markets	1,172	1,190	1,116	1,125	1,116	-1%	0%	-5%	-6%
Wealth Solutions	742	1,043	899	916	1,064	16%	18%	43%	2%
Investment Products	544	778	668	686	849	24%	27%	56%	9%
Bancassurance	198	265	232	228	215	-6%	-7%	9%	-19%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	313	296	282	307	281	-8%	0%	-10%	-5%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,004	1,017	1,017	1,018	1,032	1%	1%	3%	1%
Treasury & Other	274	181	58	72	16	-	-	-	-

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (Overweight; Price Target: 2270.0p)

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as offering strong EPS growth potential (JPMe +19% CAGR 25-28E) at attractive valuations of c10x PE 27E compared to international peers, supported by structural growth drivers and balance sheet growth. We forecast revenue CAGR of +6.3% 25-28E and operating leverage annually to drive the CIR lower to c57% 27E, underpinned by the Group's scalable technology infrastructure and cost-saving initiatives (e.g. >15% corporate function headcount reduction by 30E, c20% increase in income/employee by 28E). We also see favourable business mix changes towards Wealth and Financial Institutions/network income within the CIB to drive ROTE >15% 28E (vs JPMe 15.7%) with the trajectory to continue higher thereafter. We see capital allocation more balanced across dividends (JPMe 34-35% div payout), RWA growth and buybacks, with optionality for further growth opportunities should the environment be conducive.

Valuation

We value StanChart using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 9.0x P/E, and Consumer, Private & Business Banking Commercial at 10.0x P/E. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-27 PT is 2,270p.

StanChart SOP

£m

£ MILLION Division	Post Tax Profit 2028E	Allocated B4 Equity 2028E	RWAs £ bn 2028E	Valuation Basis	£ mn Value	£ Per Share	(x) PE	(x) P/BV
Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking	3,866	22,184	170.6	P/E	34,798	17.27	9.0	
Consumer, Private and Business Banking	2,332	6,254	48.1	P/E	23,321	11.57	10.0	
Corporate centre and other	-993	2,680	20.6	P/E	-8,939	-4.44	9.0	
Capital Excess		1,070		1x BV	1,070	0.53		1.0
Standard Chartered Group	5,205	32,187	239.4		50,249	24.9	9.7	
Standard Chartered Group (Dec-2027)						22.7		

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macro-economic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macro-economic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures (given import dependencies e.g. energy), depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. The Group is also interest rate sensitive and therefore earnings may adjust higher or lower depending on the rate environment.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions at normalised levels across the medium term given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regard to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to changes in the regulatory environment in the UK, with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the Group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690
03-Nov-25	OW	1560	1,770
02-Dec-25	OW	1681	1,880
05-Feb-26	OW	1857	2,170
25-Feb-26	OW	1789	2,200
06-May-26	OW	1819	2,220
21-Jul-26	OW	2080	2,270

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IB clients**	95%	92%	87%

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Completed 29 Jul 2026 05:13 AM BST

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